

VEER

101 Everyday Things to Ask Claude

Open to any page. Find something worth trying today.

How to use this

This isn't a book to read. It's a book to open at random when you're not sure what to do with this thing.

Every line is ready to type. Nothing to fill in, nothing to work out first. Type it, or say it, exactly as written.

Change anything you like. These are starting points, not spells. Swapping a detail for your own makes them better, not broken.

Most of them expect a conversation. Many will ask you a question back. That's deliberate — the answer gets much better once it knows your situation.

If one doesn't work, say so. *That's not quite it, what I actually meant was...* is a normal part of using this, not a sign you did it wrong.

01

Around the house

TYPE ANY OF THESE

My washing machine is making a grinding noise during the spin cycle. Walk me through what to check before I call someone out.

I'm going to describe a stain and what fabric it's on, and I'd like the best way to get it out.

Give me a realistic cleaning routine for a small flat that takes twenty minutes a day.

I have a cupboard full of half-used cleaning products. Tell me which ones I actually need and which are duplicates.

Explain how to bleed a radiator, one step at a time, as if I've never held a spanner.

I want to hang a heavy mirror on a plasterboard wall. What fixings do I need, and what could go wrong?

Help me work out a sensible order to declutter a spare room I've been avoiding for two years.

My electricity bill has gone up and I don't know why. Ask me about my home and my habits, then tell me what to check.

I'm going to paste the text from my oven manual. Tell me how to set the timer.

Write me a simple house maintenance checklist, split into monthly, seasonal and yearly.

02

Food and shopping

TYPE ANY OF THESE

I have chicken thighs, half a bag of spinach, rice, and not much else. Give me three dinner options.

Plan a week of dinners for two people who are tired on weeknights and have more time at the weekend.

I'm cooking for someone who doesn't eat dairy and I've never done that before. What should I watch out for?

Turn this recipe into a shopping list, grouped by where things sit in the supermarket.

I always throw away half a bag of salad. Give me realistic ways to actually use it up.

I'll describe two similar products. Explain the difference and tell me whether the dearer one is worth it.

Scale this recipe from four people to seven, and tell me what doesn't scale neatly.

I want to spend less on food without eating badly. Ask me how I shop at the moment, then suggest changes.

What can I make for a party where half the guests are vegetarian and I only have one oven?

Give me five things I can cook in under fifteen minutes that aren't pasta.

03

Messages you don't want to write

TYPE ANY OF THESE

Help me tell a friend I can't make their wedding, without it sounding like an excuse.

Write a message to a neighbour whose dog barks all day, that won't start a feud.

I need to chase an invoice that's six weeks overdue, and I want to stay on good terms.

Help me write a condolence message to a colleague whose father has died. I never met him.

I have to say no to helping at a school event again. Write something kind and final.

Draft a complaint about a delivery that arrived broken, written so it actually gets a response.

Write a message setting a boundary with a relative who keeps dropping in unannounced.

Help me apologise properly for something that was my fault, without over-explaining myself.

I need to ask my landlord to fix something for the third time. Firm, but not aggressive.

I'll paste a message I've drafted. Rewrite it to sound less passive-aggressive.

04

Making sense of confusing things

TYPE ANY OF THESE

I'm going to paste a letter. Tell me what it actually says and whether I need to do anything.

Explain what this warranty covers and, more importantly, what it doesn't.

I've been asked to sign something at work and there are two paragraphs I don't understand.

Turn this set of instructions into numbered steps I can follow.

Explain what this term means as if I'd never heard it, with an everyday example.

Summarise this long email thread and tell me the three things I actually need to do.

I keep getting letters about a change to my pension and I don't understand them.

Explain what happens next in this process, and roughly how long each stage takes.

What questions should I be asking about this that I probably haven't thought of?

Read this and tell me whether anything in it should worry me.

05

Money and paperwork

UNDERSTAND AND PREPARE — THEN CHECK WITH A PERSON

Everything in this chapter is for making sense of something, not for deciding. Money decisions go to someone qualified.

Explain what each line on this bill means. I'll paste it in with the account number removed.

My bill is higher than last month. Ask me questions to work out why.

Explain the difference between these two insurance options in plain English.

Help me write down the questions I should ask before signing up for this.

I'll describe a subscription I want to cancel. Walk me through how to do it.

Help me build a simple monthly budget from figures I'll give you.

Explain what this letter about tax is asking me for.

I think I've been overcharged. Help me draft the message, and tell me what evidence to gather first.

Explain what an excess is, and how it changes what I'd actually pay.

Help me compare these two quotes, and tell me what isn't included in either one.

06

Doctor's appointments

FOR PREPARING AND UNDERSTANDING ONLY

Use these to walk in ready and to make sense of what you were told. The medical decisions stay with your doctor.

I have an appointment about an ongoing problem. Help me write down what to tell them.

Explain what this test is for, and what the result would mean either way.

I didn't follow what the doctor said. Here's what I remember — explain it in plain English.

Help me write a timeline of my symptoms so I don't forget anything in the room.

What questions should I ask before agreeing to this procedure?

Explain what this medication is for, and what I should ask about side effects.

Help me prepare for a difficult conversation about a relative's care.

I have ten minutes with the doctor. Help me work out what matters most to raise.

Explain the difference between these two kinds of specialist, and which one my problem sounds like.

Help me write down what happened, for a form I have to fill in.

07

Family and children

TYPE ANY OF THESE

My child is stuck on long division. Explain it the way a patient teacher would, without giving the answers.

Ask my child questions about the book they're reading, to check they've understood it.

Help me explain a death in the family to a six-year-old.

Give me ten questions worth asking at a parents' evening.

My teenager wants to argue about something and I want to actually listen. Help me prepare.

Suggest things to do with a bored eight-year-old on a rainy afternoon that don't involve buying anything.

Help me write a note to a teacher about something my child is finding hard.

Explain what this school report actually means.

Help me split the household jobs fairly between four people, and write it up.

Give me a way to practise times tables that isn't a worksheet.

08

Going places

TYPE ANY OF THESE

Plan three days away for two people who hate rushing, with one thing booked per day.

Give me a packing list for a week away in cold weather, with hand luggage only.

I'm nervous about a journey I've not done before. Walk me through what happens at each stage.

I'll tell you where I'm staying. Suggest somewhere to eat, and what to check before booking.

Help me plan a day out that works for a wheelchair user and a toddler at the same time.

What do people usually forget to sort out before travelling?

Help me write to a hotel about a problem with my booking.

Give me a realistic driving route with sensible stops, for a long trip with children.

Explain what this ticket actually allows me to do.

Help me decide between two dates for a trip. Ask me what matters first.

09

Learning something

TYPE ANY OF THESE

Teach me the basics of this one small step at a time, and check I've understood before moving on.

I want to learn a language for a trip in six months. Make me a realistic weekly plan.

Explain this concept three different ways until one of them clicks.

Quiz me on what I've learned so far, and tell me what I keep getting wrong.

I've been practising for a month and I've stopped improving. Ask me questions, then suggest what to change.

Explain this rule, then give me five examples to work through.

I want to understand how this works, not only how to use it. Start from the beginning.

Help me practise a conversation in another language, correcting me gently as I go.

Break this skill down into the smallest first step I could take today.

Explain why the thing I've been doing is wrong, and what to do instead.

10

When you're stuck

TYPE ANY OF THESE

I'm overwhelmed and don't know where to start. Ask me questions until we find the first thing.

Help me decide between two options by asking what actually matters to me, before you give an opinion.

I've been avoiding a task for two weeks. Help me work out why, and make it smaller.

Ask me five questions that would help me think this through, then wait for my answers.

I need to explain something difficult to someone. Let me practise it on you first.

Turn this rambling list of everything in my head into something ordered.

What am I not thinking about here?

Help me write down what I actually want, because I can't seem to articulate it.

Give me the smallest possible version of this task, so I can start.

I keep going round in circles on this. Say it back to me plainly.

Argue the opposite of what I've said, so I can see whether I still agree.

When one doesn't work

Occasionally you'll type one of these and get something flat back. Almost always it's one of three things, and all three take seconds to fix.

It didn't know enough about your situation. These sentences are deliberately general so they fit everybody. Add a line about your circumstances and ask again in the same conversation.

It gave you too much. Say *shorter*, or *give me three options rather than an essay*, or *a list, not paragraphs*.

It answered a slightly different question. Say *that's not quite what I meant* and put it in your own words. You don't need to start over.

If you only do one thing

Take one line from this book and leave the other hundred.

"Ask me five questions that would help me think this through, then wait for my answers."

It works on almost anything — a decision, a problem, a task you're avoiding, a conversation you're dreading. It flips the thing from something that hands you an answer into something that helps you find your own. And it's the line people report coming back to long after they've forgotten the rest.

If nothing else in this book ever gets used, that was worth it.

Do this next

Not set up yet? → Your First Ten Minutes With Claude — six pages, free, one result you'd show someone.

Want to know how it works rather than only what to type? → Claude for Absolute Beginners — the account, the screen, and the habits that make it work.

Cautious about privacy, or about being misled? → Is This Safe? — what it can and can't see, why it's sometimes wrong, and the short list of things never to type in.

Want your own asks to land first time? → Asking Better Questions — how to write your own version of any line in this book.

The Everyday Claude Guides — start where you are.

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